

CANNING FRUITS

Adults

Q

What is the recommended headspace to leave when canning fruits in jars?

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ANSWER

1/2 inch

FUN FACT

Proper headspace helps ensure a vacuum seal and prevents spoilage.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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Which method of packing fruit usually results in less floating fruit and better color protection?

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ANSWER

Hot pack

FUN FACT

Heating fruits before packing allows firmer, better-looking canned fruit.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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When water bath canning fruits, how far above the jar tops should the boiling water be in the canner?

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ANSWER

1 to 2 inches

FUN FACT

Keeping water above jars during processing ensures even heating and safe preservation.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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Q

For raw-packed fruit in canning jars, at what minimum water temperature should the jars be preheated before filling?

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ANSWER

140°F

FUN FACT

Preheating jars reduces the risk of breakage when filled with hot syrup or juice.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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Why should you not retighten screw bands on jars after processing and cooling?

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ANSWER

Retightening can cut the lid gasket and cause seal failure

FUN FACT

Proper lid tightness is critical for safe sealing and food preservation.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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What is the function of sugar syrup in canning fruits?

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ANSWER

It helps retain shape, texture, and color of the fruit

FUN FACT

You can safely omit sugar syrup and use water or juice instead for preservation.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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If a jar fails to seal after processing, what is the recommended action?

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ANSWER

Refrigerate and use soon or reprocess within 24 hours with a new lid

FUN FACT

Reprocessing with a new lid ensures safety and quality of canned fruit.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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What type of jars are best suited for home canning fruit?

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ANSWER

Standard Mason jars

FUN FACT

Mason jars are specifically tempered to withstand canning heat and seal properly.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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When using raw pack method for canning fruit, what temperature should the syrup or juice added be?

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ANSWER

Boiling

FUN FACT

Using boiling syrup or juice prevents a temperature shock that could break jars.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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How long should empty jars be sterilized if processing for less than 10 minutes?

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ANSWER

Boil for 10 minutes

FUN FACT

Sterilization ensures jars are free of microbes, protecting food safety.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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What is a sign that a metal lid has successfully sealed on a canned fruit jar?

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ANSWER

The lid is concave and does not move when pressed

FUN FACT

A sealed lid gives an audible ring when tapped, indicating vacuum inside.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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Why should you avoid soaking fresh fruit in water before canning?

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ANSWER

Soaking lowers quality and increases risk of spoilage

FUN FACT

Washing in cool running water or multiple rinses is safer for fruit texture.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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What happens if a jar is overfilled, leaving too little headspace before water bath canning fruit?

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ANSWER

Some contents may bubble out, preventing a proper seal

FUN FACT

Correct headspace helps exhaust air and forms a safe vacuum seal during processing.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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When canning Asian pears, what is added to the jars to ensure safety due to lower acidity?

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ANSWER

Bottled lemon juice

FUN FACT

Adding lemon juice boosts acidity, preventing microbial growth in low-acid fruits.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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Q

How can you test a freshly canned fruit jar for a vacuum seal?

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ANSWER

Press the center of the lid and check for no movement

FUN FACT

Another test is tapping the lid - a clear ringing indicates a good seal.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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Q

What is a disadvantage of raw pack canning compared to hot pack?

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ANSWER

Fruit texture is firmer but there is more floating fruit

FUN FACT

Raw pack has shorter preparation but can lead to less visually appealing canned fruit.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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What do you do if water in a boiling water canner stops boiling during fruit processing?

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ANSWER

Bring water back to a boil and restart the timing process

FUN FACT

Continuous boiling ensures fruits are safely processed at proper temperature.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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Why should jars be cooled on a rack or cloth after canning instead of cold surfaces?

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ANSWER

To allow air circulation and prevent jar breakage

FUN FACT

Avoid cold drafts that can cause jar lids to loosen or food spoilage.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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What is one reason why some white-flesh peaches should not be canned by boiling water canning?

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ANSWER

They may have a natural pH that is too high to ensure safety

FUN FACT

Freezing is the safe alternative for preserving white-flesh peaches at home.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

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What should you do with screw bands on jars after they have cooled and sealed?

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ANSWER

Remove screw bands to prevent rusting

FUN FACT

Removing screw bands helps extend the storage life of canned fruit jars.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits